INCH-POUND

MIL-DTL-46186B (MR)
w/AMENDMENT 1
5 January 2026
SUPERSEDING
MIL-DTL-46186B (MR)
18 September 2022

DETAIL SPECIFICATION

# ARMOR PLATE, STEEL, WROUGHT, VERY HIGH HARDNESS

## 1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers quenched and tempered very high hardness wrought steel armor (VHA) plate for lightweight armor applications for ordered thicknesses from 0.098 inches (2.5 mm) up to an ordered thickness of 0.630 inches (16 mm), inclusive (see 6.1, 6.2, and 6.3). The major intent of VHA is an armor appliqué.

1.1.1 Cross-application. Plates produced to this revision can be used where previous revisions are specified. Revision B, amendment 1 plates can be used where drawings call for prior revisions.

1.2 Classification. Wrought armor should be of the following classes as specified (see 6.2).

1.2.1 Class 1. Wrought armor plate which is designed for better resistance to penetration than MIL-DTL-46100 (see 6.1.1).

1.2.2 Class 2. Wrought armor plate which is designed for better resistance to penetration and toughness than class 1 (see 6.1.2).

Comments, suggestions, or questions on this document should be addressed to: Director, U.S. Army DEVCOM Army Research Laboratory, Army Research Directorate, Specifications and Standards Office, Attn: FCDD-RLA-M, Aberdeen Proving Ground, MD 21005-5069. Since contact information can change, you may want to verify the currency of this address information using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil/.

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## 2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 General. The documents listed in this section are specified in sections 3 and 4 of this specification. This section does not include documents cited in other sections of this specification or recommended for additional information or as examples. While every effort has been made to ensure the completeness of this list, document users are cautioned that they must meet all specified requirements of documents cited in sections 3 and 4 of this specification, whether or not they are listed.

2.2 Government documents.

2.2.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE SPECIFICATIONS

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| MIL-DTL-32332 | - | Armor Plate, Steel, Wrought, Ultra-High-Hardness |
| MIL-DTL-46100 | - | Armor Plate, Steel, Wrought, High-Hardness |

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE STANDARDS

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| MIL-STD-129 | - | Military Marking for Shipment and Storage |
| MIL-STD-662 | - | V50 Ballistic Test for Armor |
| MIL-STD-3040 | - | Arc Welding of Armor Grade Steel |

(Copies of this document are available online at https://quicksearch.dla.mil/.)

2.2.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

TEST OPERATING PROCEDURES

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| TOP 2-2-711 | - | Proofing Projectile Impact Testing of Armor Weldments |

(Copies of these documents are available online at https://quicksearch.dla.mil/).

2.3 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.



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AMERICAN SOCIETY OF NONDESTRUCTIVE TESTING

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| ANSI/ASNT CP-189 | - | ASNT Standard for Qualification and Certification of Nondestructive Testing Personnel |

(Copies of this document are available online at https://www.asnt.org/store.)

AEROSPACE INDUSTRIES ASSOCIATION

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| AIA/NAS - NAS410 | - | NAS Certification and Qualification of Nondestructive Test Personnel Amendment |

(Copies of this document are available online at https://standards.globalspec.com/.)

ASTM INTERNATIONAL

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| ASTM A6/A6M | - | Standard Specification for General Requirements for Rolled Structural Steel Bars, Plates, Shapes and Sheet Piling |
| ASTM A370 | - | Standard Test Methods and Definitions for Mechanical Testing of Steel Products |
| ASTM A578/ A578M | - | Standard Specification for Straight-Beam Ultrasonic Examination of Rolled Steel Plates for Special Applications |
| ASTM A751 | - | Standard Test Methods, Practices, and Terminology for Chemical Analysis of Steel Products |
| ASTM E10 | - | Standard Test Method for Brinell Hardness of Metallic Materials |
| ASTM E18 | - | Standard Test Methods for Rockwell Hardness of Metallic Materials |
| ASTM E23 | - | Standard Test Methods for Notched Bar Impact Testing of Metallic Materials |
| ASTM E110 | - | Standard Test Method for Indentation Hardness of Metallic Materials by Portable Hardness Testers |
| ASTM E290 | - | Standard Test Methods for Bend Testing of Material for Ductility |
| ASTM E350 | - | Standard Test Methods for Chemical Analysis of Carbon Steel, Low-Alloy Steel, Silicon Electrical Steel, Ingot Iron, and Wrought Iron |
| ASTM E384 | - | Standard Test Method for Microindentation Hardness of Materials |

(Copies of these documents are available online at https://www.astm.org.)



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2.4 Order of precedence. Unless otherwise noted herein or in the contract, in the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein (except for related specification sheets), the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

## 3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2, 6.4, and 6.8), a sample or samples of the specified item shall be made available to the contracting officer or their authorized representative for approval in accordance with 4.4. The contractor shall comply with this requirement at the time of their first order or contract and at any time that the supplier has not furnished very high hard armor in the applicable thickness range under this specification within a period of 37 months. The approval of the first article samples authorizes the commencement of shipment but does not relieve the supplier of responsibility for compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification, namely conformance or production acceptance. The first article samples and test plates shall be manufactured by the process proposed for use on production armor. This process shall be inspected by a cognizant government representative to ensure compliance with the details of this specification. The manufacturer's declared chemical analysis shall be submitted to the contracting agency (or purchasing activity) and to the ballistic test agency. The ballistic test agency shall record the first article ballistic test plates submitted, showing the dates tested. Requests from the procuring activity to the ballistic test agency as to prior conformance with first article tests shall be accompanied by copies of the first article test firing records. Any deviation(s) noticed by the ballistic agency shall be brought to the attention of the contracting activity and to the manufacturer. After first article testing has been accepted by the contracting activity, the composition and processing shall be considered fixed. If either of these parameters change outside of the limitations allowed, then a new first article test shall be required.

3.1.1 First time producer. First time producers wishing to qualify to this specification shall follow the instructions of 6.7.

3.2 Production acceptance.

3.2.1 Chemical composition. A declared chemistry shall be submitted to the contracting agency or its authorized representative and to the ballistic test agency. The chemical composition of the declared chemistry shall conform to the requirements of table I, column A, unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2). A single heat shall not be dual certified to both MIL-DTL-46186 and MIL-DTL-46100 nor to MIL-DTL-46186 and MIL-DTL-32332. The chemical composition shall be determined by a product analysis (values shall be listed as weight percent) in accordance with 4.6.1.1 and 4.8.1. The first article samples and the production test plates shall utilize the same declared chemistry within the allowable ranges proposed for use in production. A statement showing the heat analysis of each melt and one product analysis of each lot (see 4.3) and complete details of the heat treatment of each lot shall be furnished for the files of the purchaser at no cost. All elements of the chemical composition specified in table I shall be shown in the statement. This statement shall be attached to the completed Very High Hard Armor (VHA) Test Data Form (see figure 1).



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TABLE I. Chemical composition and precision (product analysis). 4/

| ELEMENT | COLUMN A MAXIMUM LIMIT for FIRST ARTICLE & PRODUCTION CHEMISTRY (WEIGHT PERCENT) | COLUMN B 5/ ALLOWABLE RANGE for FUTURE PRODUCTION LOTS (WEIGHT PERCENT) |
|---|---|---|
| Carbon | 0.35 | 3/ |
| Manganese | NONE REQUIRED, HOWEVER IF:<br>≤ 1.00<br>> 1.00 | <br>± 0.15<br>± 0.20 |
| Phosphorus | 0.020 1/ | 3/ |
| Sulfur | 0.010 1/ | 3/ |
| Silicon | NONE REQUIRED, HOWEVER IF:<br>≤ 0.60<br>> 0.60 to ≤ 1.00<br>> 1.00 | <br>± 0.10<br>± 0.15<br>± 0.20 |
| Nickel | NONE REQUIRED 2/ | ± 0.25 |
| Chromium | NONE REQUIRED, HOWEVER IF:<br>≤ 1.25 2/<br>> 1.25 | <br>± 0.15<br>± 0.25 |
| Molybdenum | NONE REQUIRED, HOWEVER IF:<br>≤ 0.20 2/<br>> 0.20 | <br>± 0.035<br>± 0.075 |
| Vanadium | NONE REQUIRED 2/ | ± 0.075 |
| Niobium | NONE REQUIRED 2/ | ± 0.075 |
| Boron | 0.003 | 3/ |
| Copper | 0.75 2/ | 3/ |
| Nitrogen | 0.03 2/ | 3/ |
| Titanium | 0.10 2/ | 3/ |
| Zirconium | 0.10 2/ | 3/ |
| Aluminum | 0.10 2/ | 3/ |
| Lead | 0.01 2/ | 3/ |
| Tin | 0.02 2/ | 3/ |
| Antimony | 0.02 2/ | 3/ |
| Arsenic | 0.02 2/ | 3/ |

1/ Phosphorus and sulfur should be controlled to the lowest attainable levels, but in no case shall the combined phosphorus and sulfur contents exceed 0.020 wt%.

2/ When the amount of an element is less than 0.02 wt% the analysis may be reported as [ < 0.02 wt%].

3/ Product analysis values may not exceed those listed as the maximum limit.

4/ Elements not listed in table, but intentionally added, shall be reported.

5/ Values are actual tolerance limits NOT percent tolerances. The analysis from the First Article sample is the "Declared Chemistry" which is used to calculate the range.

3.2.2 Carbon equivalence. Carbon equivalence (CE) shall be calculated for each heat per ASTM A6/A6M, i.e.

$$CE = C + \frac{Mn}{6} + \frac{Cr + Mo + V}{5} + \frac{Ni + Cu}{15}$$



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where the elements are expressed in wt%.

Class 1 very high hard armor steels shall have a CE of less than 0.90 wt. %, and class 2 very high hard armor steels shall have a CE of less than 0.80 wt. %. The CE value shall be reported on the completed Very High Hard Armor (VHA) Test Data Form (see figure 1).

3.2.3 Heat treatment. All plates in each lot, including samples, shall receive the same heat treatment except for such variations in tempering temperature as shall be necessary to produce the prescribed hardness. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2), local or general heating shall not be performed after the final heat treating operation. This does not include preheating for welding or flame cutting, as long as the tempering temperature is not exceeded (see 6.6 and 6.11). The tempering temperature shall be reported on the Very High Hard Armor (VHA) Test Data Form (see figure 1).

3.2.3.1 Thermal processing. The material shall be able to withstand thermal processing for preheating, stress relieving or similar operations at a maximum temperature of 350 degrees F without affecting mechanical or ballistic properties.

3.2.4 Condition. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2), plates shall be in the as-heat treated condition; surfaces shall not be pickled.

3.2.5 Processing controls.

3.2.5.1 Requirements of heat treating furnaces. All furnaces that are used to heat treat plates must be thermally surveyed. The initial survey is done once using the thinnest and thickest gage plate. This shall be followed with annual surveys using any gage.

3.2.5.1.1 Thermal survey requirements of heat treating furnaces. Thermal surveys are conducted as follows:

a. Three contact thermocouples must be used, both edges and in the middle across the width of the plate.
b. A calibrated recording device and thermocouples must be used.
c. The test plate is run through the furnace using standard hold times.
d. Trial starts when plate exits heat-up zones, and ends when plate exits furnace.
e. Maximum temperature variability when plate is in soaking zones is +/- 25°F for tempering furnaces and +/- 50°F for austenitizing furnaces.



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| REQUEST FOR BALLISTIC TEST OF VERY HIGH HARD ARMOR | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **SPECIFICATION: MIL-DTL-46186** | **REVISION: B** | | **AMENDMENT: 1** |
| **FIRING RECORD:** | **DATE:** | **TEST CONTRACT NO:** | |

| | PLATE/COIL MELTED | PLATE/COIL ROLLED | PLATE/COIL HEAT TREATED |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Name:** | | | |
| **Address:** | | | |
| **POC:** | | | |
| **Phone No.** | | | |
| **Email:** | | | |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **TEST ITEM IDENTIFICATION:**_____ | | Ordered Thickness: _____ |
| Lot No. _____<br>Plate No._____ | VHA Classification CLASS: _____<br>Carbon Equivalence (CE): _____ | Austenizing Temp. _____<br>Tempering Temp. _____ |
| **Bend Test:** | Plate Thickness [Pass / Fail]<br>1) _____ 2) _____ | Inside Radius<br>1) _____ 2) _____ |

**PURPOSE:** _____ Acceptance _____ First Article _____ Reduced Testing

**SAMPLE:** _____ Primary _____ Retest (Firing Record No. of Failed Sample _____ )

| **CHEMISTRY ANALYSIS** | C | Mn | P | S | Si | Ni | Cr | Mo |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **FIRST ARTICLE RESULTS:** | | | | | | | | |
| **PRODUCTION RESULTS:** | | | | | | | | |
| **ACCEPTANCE (Pass / Fail)** | | | | | | | | |

| | | | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V: | Nb: | B: | Cu: | N: | Sb | | | | |
| Ti: | Al: | Pb: | Sn: | As | | | | | |

**MECHANICAL PROPERTIES:** **CHARPY IMPACT @ -40 Degs. F.** **Specimen Size:**_____

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **HARDNESS:** _____ | **LT Direction: 1:** _____ **2:** _____ **3:** _____ | **TL Direction: 1:** _____ **2:** _____ **3:** _____ |

**BALLISTIC TEST RESULTS: SEPARATELY HEAT TREATED TEST PLATE: YES** _____ **NO** _____

| | Obl. (deg) | Actual Thickness (in) | Required $V_{50}$ (ft/sec) | Actual $V_{50}$ (ft/sec) | Pass/ Fail |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Test:** | | | | | |
| | | | | | |
| **Projectile:** | | | | | |
| | **NOTES:** | | | | |

DO NOT FILL BELOW THIS LINE - TO BE COMPLETED BY GOVERNMENT & SUPPLIER OFFICIALS

**LOT:** [ _____ met ] [ _____ failed to meet ] the ballistic requirements of specification MIL-DTL-46186

| Government Representative: | Date: | Supplier Representative: | Date: |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |

FIGURE 1. Very High Hard Armor (VHA) Test Data Form.



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3.2.6 Mechanical properties.

3.2.6.1 Hardness. The surface hardness of each plate, including first article samples, shall be between 530 and 570 HBW. The diameters of Brinell hardness impressions on any individual plate shall not vary by more than 0.10 mm (see 4.8.2).

3.2.6.2 Impact resistance. The minimum average Charpy V-notch impact resistance requirement of the armor plate shall be as shown in table II. The Charpy V-notch specimens shall be obtained in the TL orientation (i.e., transverse to the major direction of rolling with the notch perpendicular to the plate surface so that the crack shall propagate in the longitudinal direction) and the LT orientation (i.e., parallel to the major direction of rolling).

TABLE II. Minimum Charpy V-notch impact resistance requirements at -40°F ± 2°F.

| SPECIMEN ORIENTATION | IMPACT RESISTANCE (ft. lbs.) | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Standard width | | 3/4 width | | 1/2 width | | 1/4 width | |
| | Class 1 | Class 2 | Class 1 | Class 2 | Class 1 | Class 2 | Class 1 | Class 2 |
| Transverse (TL) | 10.0 | 12.0 | 7.5 | 9.0 | 5.0 | 6.0 | 2.5 | 3.0 |
| Longitudinal (LT) | 12.0 | 14.0 | 9.0 | 10.5 | 6.0 | 7.0 | 3.0 | 3.5 |

3.2.7 Bend test. All bend test samples from that lot shall be capable of being bent to the requirements specified in table III without cracking as determined by visual inspection for thicknesses of 0.500 inches and under. When specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2), the bend test shall be performed on material thicker than 0.500 inch. Dimensions for thickness over 0.500 inches are listed in table III for information purposes only. Two bend test samples shall be tested in the transverse direction per ASTM E290, transverse bend test, at room temperature through an included angle of 90° (unrestrained) to the inside radii shown below. After bending, samples shall be free of cracks as determined by visual inspection unless otherwise specified in the contract or order (see 6.2).

TABLE III. Bend test requirements.

| PLATE THICKNESS (T) | INSIDE RADIUS |
|---|---|
| 0.098 to 0.3125 | 6T |
| Over 0.3125 to 0.500 | 8T |
| Over 0.500 to 0.750 | 10T |
| Over 0.750 to 1.000 | 12T |
| Over 1.000 to 2.000 | 14T |

3.2.8 Ballistic requirements. Ballistic requirements shall be in accordance with the Appendix A of this specification.

3.2.8.1 Ballistic test plate information. For each lot of very high hard armor plate a properly completed Very High Hard Armor Test Data Form (see figure 1) shall be submitted with each ballistic test plate that represents that particular processing lot. If another form, such as a Material Test Report or a Test Certificate, that contains the same information as in figure 1, is available, it can be used in combination with figure 1, unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase



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order (see 6.2). This additional form shall be attached to figure 1 and submitted with each ballistic test plate.

3.2.9 Dimensions and tolerances.

3.2.9.1 Dimensions. Plates shall comply with the dimensions specified in the applicable drawings or in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2). Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order (see 6.2), dimensional tolerances will be in accordance with ASTM A6/A6M.

3.2.9.2 Thickness. The thickness tolerance of each plate, after final treatment, shall be in accordance with table IV for the thickness specified.

3.2.9.3 Flatness. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order (see 6.2), the flatness tolerance of each plate shall be within the requirements specified in ASTM A6/A6M for hot rolled or thermally treated plates. Tighter tolerance requirements shall be specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2) and shall be as agreed upon between the contractor and the procuring activity.

3.2.9.4 Waviness. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2), the waviness tolerance of each plate shall be within the requirements of ASTM A6/A6M.

3.2.10 Identification marking. Identification marking shall be legibly painted and records shall be such as to ensure positive identification of all plates, including test samples and specimens, with the lot and corresponding heat from which they were produced. Marking shall be approximately six inches in from the edge of the plate. The key to identification symbols shall be furnished to the inspector prior to submittal for inspection. First article and acceptance ballistic test plates shall also be marked with the manufacturer's name or trademark, the number of this specification, and the ordered plate thickness in inches. First article plates shall be marked "PRE," acceptance plates “ACC," and retest plates shall be marked “Rl” and “R2”. If a second set of retest plates are submitted, they shall be marked “RR1” and “RR2”.

3.2.10.1 Identification by stamping. Stamping is not allowed unless the finished rolled plates are stamped “hot” (>600$^{o}$ F for plates greater than 3/8 inch thick and >500$^{o}$ F for plates 3/8 inch thick and under) with a stamp having a minimal surface distortion or residual stress. The plate shall be hot stamped prior to austenization.



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TABLE IV. Thickness tolerances for ordered thickness [1/], inches (over and under). [2/]

| Specified Thickness, inches | Tolerances over and under ordered thickness for widths given, inches | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | to 72 excl. | 72 to 84 excl. | 84 to 96 excl. | 96 to 108 excl. | 108 to 120 excl. | 120 to 132 excl. | 132 to 144 incl. |
| 0.098 | 0.012 | 0.012 | 0.014 | 0.014 | 0.017 | --- | --- |
| 0.1180 | 0.012 | 0.012 | 0.014 | 0.014 | 0.017 | --- | --- |
| 0.1250 | 0.012 | 0.012 | 0.014 | 0.014 | 0.017 | --- | --- |
| 0.1875 | 0.012 | 0.012 | 0.014 | 0.014 | 0.017 | --- | --- |
| 0.2500 | 0.012 | 0.012 | 0.014 | 0.014 | 0.017 | --- | --- |
| 0.3125 | 0.012 | 0.014 | 0.014 | 0.014 | 0.017 | 0.02 | --- |
| 0.3750 | 0.012 | 0.014 | 0.014 | 0.017 | 0.017 | 0.02 | --- |
| 0.4375 | 0.012 | 0.014 | 0.014 | 0.017 | 0.02 | 0.02 | 0.023 |
| 0.5000 | 0.012 | 0.014 | 0.014 | 0.017 | 0.02 | 0.02 | 0.023 |
| 0.5625 | 0.014 | 0.014 | 0.014 | 0.017 | 0.02 | 0.023 | 0.023 |
| 0.6300 | 0.014 | 0.014 | 0.014 | 0.017 | 0.02 | 0.023 | 0.023 |

[1/] For intermediate thickness, the tolerance of the closer specified gage shall apply. In case of mid-point, the tolerance for lower gage or interpolated value shall apply.
[2/] When plates under 60 inches are rolled double width, the equivalent wider plate tolerance shall apply.

3.2.11 Workmanship.

3.2.11.1 Surface condition. The top and bottom surface of each plate shall be free from the following surface defects: slivers, laps, checks, seams, blisters, snakes, cold shuts, cracks, burning, mechanical seams, mechanical gouges and laminations (see 6.9). The surface of each plate shall be such that mill scale or oxidation product shall not interfere with determination of acceptability. Imperfections listed above, which are of such a nature as to affect the fabrication of the materials, shall be rejected.

3.2.11.1.1 Depth of imperfections. The depth of rolled-in scale, scale pitting or snakes shall not exceed 0.015 inch and shall not reduce the steel thickness below the allowable minimum. Isolated individual pits over 0.015 inch deep but not over 0.03 inch deep and not within 6 inches of each other and which do not violate the minimum allowable thickness, as specified in the applicable drawings and fabrication documents, are acceptable.

3.2.11.2 Internal soundness. One plate from every lot that has an ordered thickness greater than 0.500 inch shall be ultrasonically examined for internal soundness in accordance with 4.8.6. The acceptance level shall be Level C as defined in ASTM A578/A578M, unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2).

3.2.11.3 Edge preparation and quality.

3.2.11.3.1 Plate. Thermal cutting of production plate shall be permitted after final heat treatment provided the procedure, which may include grinding after thermal cutting, is such that no cracks develop on any thermally cut edge whether detected by nondestructive inspection, or as agreed upon in the contract. The heat affected zone of thermally cut plates (up to and including 0.500 inches in thickness) shall not exceed 1.2 times the plate's thickness from the cut edge. For plates



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over 0.500 inches thick, the heat affected zone shall not exceed 0.625 inches from the cut edge. Approval shall be obtained from the procuring activity and shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2) in order to have the heat affected zone exceed these limits. To reduce the potential for plate cracking, plates shall not be cut by cold shearing after final heat treatment, unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2). For plates that will be cut with a pattern of piece parts from within the edges of the plate, the condition of the discarded material shall not require inspection as long as cracks do not infringe into the pattern.

3.2.11.3.2 Piece parts cut from plate. For sections of production plate that are thermally cut to size for a specific order from the vehicle fabricator, the supplier shall practice such necessary process controls to prevent edge cracking. For all piece parts, the supplier shall institute such necessary process inspection such that any cut edges shall comply with the requirements of 3.2.11.3.2.1.1 and 3.2.11.3.2.1.2 using magnetic particle inspection, or liquid penetrant inspection. If the supplier can demonstrate excellent edge integrity history, then NDT inspection can be reduced to 1 out of every 25 parts with 100% visual inspection on all parts.

3.2.11.3.2.1 Acceptance criteria.

3.2.11.3.2.1.1 Single linear indications. In any four inches of length a single linear indication shall not exceed twice the plate thickness.

3.2.11.3.2.1.2 Multiple linear indications. Multiple linear indications shall not exceed 1.5 times the plate thickness if two or more lie in the same plane. The total length of indications in one plane, in any four inch length, shall not exceed twice the plate thickness. No more than ten indications, whether in one plane or multiple planes, are permitted in any four inch length.

3.2.11.3.2.1.3 Removal of large indications. Rejectable indications shall be removed by the manufacturer or processor by grinding, provided the resulting cavity does not exceed 10 % of the ordered thickness. Weld repair is acceptable as long as it is done before the final heat treatment. Weld repair shall not be done after final heat treatment.

## 4. VERIFICATION

4.1 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Production acceptance inspection (see 4.5).

4.2 Testing responsibility and facilities. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2), the contractor is responsible for the performance of all the requirements as specified herein. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2), the contractor may use their own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the requirements specified herein, except ballistic tests (see 4.2.1), unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform or check any of the inspections set forth in this specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements and to determine the validity of the certifications.



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4.2.1 Ballistic testing facility. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2), the ballistic test plates shall be forwarded to the Commander, USAATC, ATTN: TEAT-LFS, 6850 Lanyard Road, Building 358, APG, MD 21005-5059 or to an approved Government facility for ballistic testing for first article or production acceptance.

4.3 Lot. A lot shall consist of all production and ballistic test plates of the same melt of steel, of the same thickness, having the same treatment, and heat treated using the same thermal cycle process in the same production heating and cooling equipment in the same facility. When specified by the procuring activity (see 4.3.1 and 6.2), production and ballistic test plates shall be allowed to be heat treated separately. The test plate shall be heat treated and processed using production facilities.

4.3.1 Separately heat treated ballistic test plate. When the procuring activity allows a ballistic test plate to be heat treated separately from the production plates it represents (see 4.3), it shall be so stated in the data (see 6.6).

4.4 First article inspection. When required (see 6.2) first article inspection, except as otherwise indicated in this specification, shall utilize the same requirements and test methods as the production acceptance inspection shown in 4.5.

4.5 Production acceptance inspection. Production acceptance inspection shall include the examination of 4.7 and the tests of 4.8.

4.6 Sampling.

4.6.1 For first article inspection.

4.6.1.1 Chemical analysis samples. One sample for chemical analysis shall be taken from near each plate selected for the ballistic tests in accordance with ASTM E350.

4.6.1.2 Impact samples. At least three (3) impact test specimens in each direction (TL & LT) shall be taken from each test plate submitted for ballistic testing.

4.6.1.3 Ballistic samples. Two (2) ballistic test plates of the same ordered thickness for each nominal thickness range shown in table V shall be submitted for ballistic testing and shall represent any other thickness in the range. One sample shall be taken from the first plate heat treated and one from the last plate heat treated in the initial lot produced. When only one plate is heat treated, a sample shall be taken from each end of the plate. The ballistic test plates shall be 12 inches by 36 inches.

4.6.1.4 Bend test samples. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2), two (2) samples shall be taken from each submitted test plate and shall be tested in accordance with 4.8.4 and shall meet the requirements of 3.2.7.



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TABLE V. Nominal thickness ranges and corresponding test projectiles for first article and acceptance testing.

| Nominal thickness range, in | Obliquity, degrees | Test Projectile | Table |
|---|---|---|---|
| 0.098 to 0.157 incl. | 0 | 7.62-mm M80 ball | A-I |
| 0.158 to 0.300 incl. | 30 | Cal .30 AP, M2 | A-II |
| 0.301 to 0.630 incl. | 30 | Cal .50 AP, M2 | A-III |

4.6.2 Sampling for production acceptance inspection.

4.6.2.1 For chemical analysis. At least one (1) sample for chemical analysis shall be taken from each heat in accordance with the applicable method specified in ASTM A751 (see 6.5).

4.6.2.2 For hardness tests. The Brinell hardness of each plate, as heat treated, shall be measured in two places, one at each end of a diagonal on one surface of the plate. Image analysis systems may be used to read the indent and compute the hardness and if the heat treating process is continuous (not batch or oscillation), then the amount of testing may be reduced to one measurement per plate.

4.6.2.3 For Charpy V-notch impact tests. A sample shall be taken from a plate representing each lot for Charpy V-notch impact tests. The sample shall be the same thickness as the plate it represents and large enough to obtain at least six specimens from the sample in accordance with 4.8.3.

4.6.2.4 For ballistic acceptance testing. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order (see 6.2), one test plate shall be submitted from each heat for each nominal thickness range (see table V). The average thickness of each test plate shall be determined at the test site by taking the average of four thickness measurements. Measurements shall be made at least 1 inch from each edge but preferably at random in the intended impact area. Thickness shall be read to the nearest 0.001 inch. If a producer submits plates outside the specified plate tolerances (see table IV), the procuring activity shall be notified. A Very High Hard Armor (VHA) Test Data Form (see figure 1) shall be completed and submitted with each ballistic test plate. In the event that plates of the same heat rolled to a different ordered thickness but with overlapping thickness tolerance ranges can be represented by one ballistic test plate, then only one of the ordered thicknesses need be submitted for acceptance testing. The other ordered thicknesses, however, shall be included on the applicable reporting form with the words indicating that it is represented by the sample to be tested. However, if the two ordered thicknesses are such that each thickness requires testing with a different type projectile as shown in table V, then each of the ordered thicknesses shall be ballistically tested. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2), the plates shall be 12 inches by 36 inches.

4.6.2.5 Bend test samples. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2), two (2) samples shall be randomly taken from each lot for these tests representing the entire lot of material; however, when an entire heat represents only one lot the samples shall be taken from the first and last usable portion of the heat. Testing shall be conducted in accordance with 4.8.4 and shall meet the requirements of 3.2.7.



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4.7 Examination.

4.7.1 Visual. All steel plate shall be subject to visual inspection for compliance with the requirements for identification marking (see 3.2.9) and for workmanship (see 3.2.10).

4.7.2 Dimensional. All steel plate shall be subject to inspection for compliance with dimensional and tolerance requirements (see 3.2.8).

4.7.3 Preparation for shipment. Examination shall be made to determine compliance with the requirements for preparation for shipment (see section 5).

4.8 Tests.

4.8.1 Chemical analysis. Chemical analysis shall be conducted in accordance with the applicable method specified in ASTM A751 (see 6.5). The analysis shall comply with the declared composition established in accordance with the requirements of table I (see 3.2.1).

4.8.2 Hardness tests. Brinell hardness tests (HBW) shall be conducted in accordance with ASTM E10 or ASTM E110 (for portable testing). Surface scale and decarburization shall be removed from the areas where the tests are to be made. However, no more than 0.040 inches shall be removed from the test area. Test area is exempt from thickness tolerance requirement. All hardness readings shall fall within the minimum value as specified in 3.2.6.1.

4.8.2.1 Hardness traverse test. Prior to production to assure compliance to paragraph 3.2.10.3.1, the size of the heat affected zone for thermally cut edges shall be determined by taking Rockwell C or Vickers Hardness tests at 0.040 inch (1.0 mm) increments from the edge in accordance with ASTM E18 or ASTM E384 respectively. Surface scale and decarburization shall be removed from the test surface. The distance at which there is no change in surface hardness shall be considered the depth of the heat affected zone. The contractor shall document the test results for each thickness and thermal cutting method used in production. The contractor is also responsible for documenting all heat input controls to assure the cutting process is under control. Re-verification of heat affected zone size for subsequent production lots is not required provided there is no change in the cutting method or heat input from that previously tested. The records shall be available for review by the cognizant government representative.

4.8.3 Charpy V-notch impact tests. At least three (3) Charpy V-notch impact test specimens per direction for a total of at least six (6) Charpy V-notch impact test specimens shall be taken from the sample and shall be prepared and tested in accordance with ASTM E23 and ASTM A370. All six (6) measured values shall be reported in the spaces provided on the VHA Test Data Form (figure 1). Charpy V-notch impact test specimens shall be taken in both the TL orientation and in the LT orientation from locations midway between the top and bottom surfaces of the plate and at least 4 inches or 2T; whichever is less, from any quenched edge as well as outside the heat affected zone of any thermally-cut edge. The largest attainable sub-size Charpy V-notch impact test specimens shall be prepared in accordance ASTM E23. There are no Charpy V-notch impact test requirements for plates less than 0.140 inches thick.



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4.8.4 Bend test. The bend test shall be conducted in accordance with ASTM E290 using the method referred to as the Guided-Bend Test.

4.8.5 Ballistic tests. Ballistic testing of armor plate shall be conducted at a Government approved test facility specified in 4.2.1, unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2). Testing shall be conducted in accordance with the requirements of Appendix A of this specification.

4.8.6 Ultrasonic examination.

4.8.6.1 Inspection equipment. The ultrasonic soundness inspection equipment shall conform to ASTM A578/A578M.

4.8.6.2 Procedure. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2), the ultrasonic examination shall be carried out in accordance with ASTM A578/A578M (see 3.2.10.2) with the following exceptions.

a. Scanning shall be continuous over 100% of the plate surface.
b. Scanning rate shall be at a speed where recordable discontinuities can be detected.
c. The testing frequency shall be a minimum of 2 megahertz (MHz).
d. Any area within a plate where a discontinuity produces a continuous total loss of back reflection accompanied by continuous indications on the same plane that cannot be encompassed within a circle whose diameter is 1 inch shall be cause for rejection of that plate.

4.8.6.3 Certification of inspection personnel. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2), personnel performing ultrasonic inspection shall comply with the qualification requirements of ANSI/ASNT CP-189 or AIA/NAS NAS410.

4.9 Reduced testing. At the discretion of the procuring activity, the amount of testing shall be reduced provided the results on consecutive lots indicate that a satisfactory uniform product meeting the testing requirements is being produced and shall be specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2). Reduced testing shall be in accordance with a system previously approved or established by the procuring activity involved.

4.10 Rejection and retest for non-ballistic requirements.

4.10.1 Rejection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order (see 6.2), failure of the first article samples to meet the requirements of this specification shall be cause for rejection of the process, failure of the acceptance sample to meet the requirements of this specification shall be cause for rejection of the lot (see 4.10.2). For ballistic rejection procedures, see A.4.1.2.

4.10.2 Retest. Unless specific retest procedure is specified in the contract or order (see 6.2), two retest samples shall be submitted for each failed sample. Failure of either of the retest samples (plates) shall be cause for rejection of the material. First article retests shall not be permitted until the supplier has made the necessary corrections in the processing of the material to the satisfaction of the procuring activity. For ballistic retest procedures, see A.4.1.2.



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## 5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. For acquisition purposes, the packaging requirements shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2). When packaging of materiel is to be performed by DoD or in-house contractor personnel, these personnel need to contact the responsible packaging activity to ascertain packaging requirements. Packaging requirements are maintained by the Inventory Control Point's packaging activities within the Military Service or Defense Agency, or within the military service's system command. Packaging data retrieval is available from the managing Military Department's or Defense Agency's automated packaging files, CD-ROM products, or by contacting the responsible packaging activity.

5.2 Marking. Plate lots shall be indelibly and legibly marked with symbols that will definitely identify the plates with inspection and test reports and with shipping documents in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

## 6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. The steel armor covered by this specification is intended for lightweight applications where resistance to ball and armor piercing types of ammunition and multiple hit capabilities are required. Although the major intent of VHA is an armor appliqué, VHA could be utilized as a welded structural plate if welded by special techniques. Because of the high carbon equivalence (CE) of the type of steel specified, it will be more difficult to weld than MIL-DTL-46100E.

6.1.1 Class 1. Class 1 wrought armor is intended for use in those areas where greater resistance to penetration by armor piercing types of ammunition than MIL-DTL-46100E (MR) is required. Generally, this is a monolithic material.

6.1.2 Class 2. Class 2 wrought armor is intended for use in those areas where greater resistance to penetration by armor piercing types of ammunition and greater toughness than class 1 is required. Generally, this is a monolithic material.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Specify ordered thickness (see 1.1) and classification (see 1.2).
c. If issues of documents are different (see 2.2.1).
d. If a different issue is to be used (see 2.2.2 and 2.3).
e. If first article samples are required (see 3.1 and 4.4).
f. If the declared chemistry composition can be different (see 3.2.1).
g. If local or general heating can be performed after final heat treating (see 3.2.3).



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h. If plates may be furnished in a condition other than that specified (see 3.2.4).
i. If a bend test is required for material greater than 0.500 inch in thickness (see 3.2.7).
j. If another inspection for determining cracks is required (see 3.2.7 and 6.12).
k. If a substitute form cannot be used in place of figure 1 (see 3.2.8.1).
l. Specify dimensions (see 3.2.9.1).
m. If dimensional tolerances can be other than in accordance with ASTM A6/A6M (see 3.2.9.1).
n. If the flatness tolerance is different than those specified (see 3.2.9.3).
o. If tighter flatness tolerance requirements are to be specified (see 3.2.9.3).
p. If the waviness tolerance is different than those specified (see 3.2.9.4).
q. Specify the acceptance level for internal soundness if other than Level C as defined in ASTM A578/A578M (see 3.2.11.2)
r. If the limits specified for heat affected zone can be exceeded (see 3.2.11.3.1).
s If plates can be cut by cold shearing after final heat treatment (see 3.2.11.3.1).
t. If someone other than the contractor is responsible for the performance of all the requirements of the specification (see 4.2).
u. If the contractor cannot use their own facility or any other facility for testing (see 4.2).
v. If the ballistic tests are to be conducted at another location (see 4.2.1 and 4.8.5).
w. If production and ballistic test plates can be heat treated separately (see 4.3).
x. If the number of bend test samples is different (see 4.6.1.4).
y. If the size of the ballistic test plates can be different (see 4.6.2.4).
z. If the bend test samples are selected other than randomly (see 4.6.2.5).
aa. If the ultrasonic test procedures are different than that specified (see 4.8.6.2).
ab. If a different certification for inspection personnel is required (see 4.8.6.3).
ac. Specify reduced testing plan when applicable (see 4.9).
ad. If rejection requirements differ (see 4.10.1).
ae. If retest requirements differ (see 4.10.2).
af. Preparation for delivery requirements (see section 5).

6.3 Fabrication. The armor plate covered by this specification is subject to fabrication involving cutting, drilling, forming, and welding. It is intended that selection and control of chemical composition, cleanliness, and plate processing should be such that the armor will be suitable for fabrication in accordance with MIL-STD-3040, entitled: “QUALIFICATION, FABRICATION, WELDING, AND INSPECTION OF ARMOR AND NON-ARMOR STEEL WELDMENTS”. The long dimension of the plate is typically the rolling direction. If a forming operation is to be performed, the rolling direction should be tracked so that bending is preferably not performed longitudinal to the rolling direction.



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6.4 Special first article ballistic test. Special first article ballistic tests are required when the manufacturer changes either the heat treatment or the declared chemistry of the armor.

6.5 Chemical analysis. Suggested ASTM instrumental methods that can be used for chemical analysis are E322 and E415. ASTM A751 should be consulted for a complete list of methods.

6.6 Production plates. Material made to this specification has tendency to develop stress cracks if not tempered as soon as possible after austenitizing treatment. To avoid this situation, all plates should be left in the hot rolled or tempered condition while waiting for the ballistic test results.

6.7 Potential suppliers. Potential suppliers who have not previously supplied armor plate to MIL-DTL-46186 and wish to have their material ballistic tested may do so at their own expense. It is recommended that inquiries for such testing be directed to Commander, USAATC, TEAT-LFS, 6943 Colleran Road, Building 400, APG, MD 21005-5059. The armor manufacturing process should be inspected by a cognizant government representative to ensure compliance with the details of this specification.

6.8 New contracts sponsored by government agencies. At the time that a new contract is initiated for the production of combat vehicles, the contractor's supplier is to estimate the number, size and delivery schedule of the ballistic test plates which are to be submitted for first article or acceptance testing. A lead time of 60 days after the contract has been signed is to be allowed prior to shipment of the first ballistic test plate(s) to APG to ensure that all administrative functions for the establishment of a new ATC project have been completed in preparation for the test. The contracting government agency is to initiate the new project through a letter to Commander, USAATC, TEAT-LFS, 6943 Colleran Road, Building 400, APG, MD 21005-5059 requesting a cost estimate for the ballistic testing of the applicable number of sizes of plates. In the case of increases in scope of existing projects, similar correspondence is needed.

6.9 Tempering. Any tempering should be performed as soon as possible after quenching. It is recommended that the delay after quenching be no greater than 24 hours to avoid cracking.

6.10 Plates in the as-rolled condition. When the fabricator performs the final quench and temper of plates, it will be their responsibility that the mechanical and ballistic requirements of the plates, meet this specification.

6.11 Bend test inspection tests. If additional tests are required in the contract or purchase order, the following could be specified: "After bending, samples should be free of cracks as determined by either penetrate inspection per ASTM E1417 or magnetic particle inspection per ASTM E1444 (see 3.2.7)".

6.12 Definitions.

6.12.1 Slivers. An imperfection consisting of a very thin elongated piece of metal attached by only one end to the parent metal into whose surface it has been worked.



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6.12.2 Laps. A surface imperfection with the appearance of a seam, caused by hot metal, fins or sharp corners being folded over and thus being forged or rolled into the surface but without being welded.

6.12.3 Checks. Checks are numerous very fine cracks at the surface of a metal part. Checks may appear during processing or during service and are most often associated with thermal cycling or thermal treatment. Also called check marks, checking, and heat checks.

6.12.4 Seams. Seams are an unwelded fold or lap that appears as a crack, usually resulting from a discontinuity on a metal surface.

6.12.5 Blisters. A raised area, often dome shaped, resulting from delamination under pressure of expanding gas trapped in metal in a near sub-surface zone. Very small blisters may be called pinhead blisters or pepper blisters.

6.12.6 Snakes. Any crooked surface imperfection in a metal plate, resembling a snake.

6.12.7 Cold shuts. A lap on the surface of a forging or billet that was closed without fusion during deformation.

6.12.8 Burning. Permanently damaged metal due to overheating enough to cause incipient melting or intergranular oxidation. Note: This condition is usually obscured by normal cleaning methods and would require deep pickling and/or metallography to note the continuous oxidation (chicken wire effect) of the enlarged grain boundaries. This defect is usually not limited to the surface and may be sub-surface or at interior locations when associated with heavy mechanical working. Metal with this condition will be scrapped.

6.12.9 Laminations. A type of discontinuity with separation or weakness generally aligned parallel to direction of the worked surface of the metal and may be the result of pipe blisters, seams, inclusions, or segregation elongated and made directional by working.

6.12.10 Linear indication. For nondestructive examination purposes, a linear indication is evidence of a discontinuity that requires interpretation to determine its significance.

6.12.11 Autotempering. When the martensite start temperature ($M_S$) lies well above room temperature, carbide precipitation (tempering) occurs upon quenching, after the transformation to martensite. This is also called quench tempering.

6.12.12 Crack. A crack is a planar discontinuity in the metal that has length and depth. Cracks may be surface cracks or through cracks.

6.12.13 Quenched and Tempered. Processing of armor plate utilizing a process to cool from austenitic-phase field through the martensitic transformation utilizing air and/or liquid quenching media followed by tempering.



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6.13 Metric units. When metric dimensions are required, units for inch, foot, foot-pounds and feet per second may be converted to the metric equivalent by multiplying them by the following conversion factors listed in table VI.

TABLE VI. Conversion factors.

| English | Multiply by | Equals | Metric SI unit |
|---|---|---|---|
| inch | 0.0254 | = | meter (m) |
| foot | 0.3048 | = | meter (m) |
| pound | 0.4536 | = | kilogram (kg) |
| foot-lb | 1.3558 | = | joule (j) |
| feet/sec | 0.3048 | = | meter per second (m/s) |
| Fahrenheit (°F) | (t°F - 32)/1.8 = t°C | | Celsius (°C) |

Note: Conversion factors can be associated with ASTM E380 entitled "Metric Practice Guide."

6.14 Subject term (key word) listing.

Ballistic limit
Ballistic plate
Ballistic testing
Batch tempering
Continuous tempering
Heat treated
Lightweight material
M2 projectile
M80 projectile

6.15 Amendment notations. The margins of this specification are marked with vertical lines to indicate modifications generated by this amendment. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations.



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# APPENDIX A

## BALLISTIC TESTING OF ARMOR PLATE, STEEL, WROUGHT VERY HIGH HARDNESS

### A.1 SCOPE

A.1.1 This appendix covers the requirements for ballistic testing of very high hardness steel armor plate.

### A.2 DEFINITIONS

A.2.1 Fair impact. A fair impact is an impact resulting from the striking of the test plate by a projectile in normal flight (no yawing or tumbling) and separated from another impact or the edge of the plate, hole, crack, or spalled area by an undisturbed area of at least three inches.

A.2.2 Witness sheet. A witness sheet is normally a 0.014 inch thick sheet of 5052 H36 aluminum alloy (or a 0.020 inch thick sheet of 2024 -T3 aluminum alloy) placed 6 inches (+ 0.5 inch) behind and parallel to the test plate or other ballistic sample.

A.2.3 Complete penetration, protection, CP(P). A protection complete penetration is a penetration in which the projectile or one or more fragments of the projectile or plate pass beyond the back of the test plate and perforates the witness plate.

A.2.4 Partial penetration, protection, PP(P). A partial penetration is any impact that is not a complete penetration.

A.2.5 Gap. The difference in velocity between the high partial penetration velocity and the low complete penetration velocity used in computing the ballistic limit where the high partial penetration velocity is lower than the low complete penetration velocity.

A.2.6 $V_{50}$ protection ballistic limit, BL(P). The protection $V_{50}$ ballistic limit is defined as the average of 6 fair impact velocities comprising the three lowest velocities resulting in complete penetration and the three highest velocities resulting in partial penetration. A maximum spread of 150 feet per second (fps) shall be permitted between the lowest and highest velocities employed in determination of ballistic limits. In only those cases where the lowest complete penetration velocity is lower than the highest partial penetration velocity by more than 150 fps shall the ballistic limit be based on 10 velocities (the 5 lowest velocities that resulted in complete penetration and the 5 highest velocities that resulted in partial penetrations). When the 10-round excessive spread, ballistic limit is used, the velocity spread shall be reduced to the lowest practical level (as close to 150 fps as possible). When a 10-round ballistic limit is used, this shall be noted in all reports. The normal up-and-down firing method shall be used in the determination of all BL(P)'s, all velocities being corrected to striking velocity. In the event that the ballistic limit computed is less than 30 fps above the minimum required and if a gap (high partial penetration velocity below the low complete penetration velocity) of 30 fps or more exists, firing shall continue as needed to reduce this gap to 25 fps or less. (This procedure shall insure better evaluation of the steel when the ballistic limit is near the minimum required.)



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A.2.7 Thickness, impact area. The thickness of ballistic test plates used for determining ballistic limits shall be that of the area subjected to the ballistic testing.

A.3 REQUIREMENTS

A.3.1 Resistance to penetration. The minimum ballistic limits shall be in accordance with the values shown in tables A-I through A-III, as applicable.

A.3.2 Impact spacing. All testing shall be conducted on only one plate per $V_{50}$ in accordance with A.4.1 with all impacts at least 3 inches from an edge, a crack, or a previous impact. Failure to meet these conditions shall be cause for rejection of that plate.

A.4 TESTS

A.4.1 Ballistic tests. $V_{50}$ ballistic tests shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-662, V50 Ballistic Test for Armor to determine compliance with the requirements of tables A-I through A-III.

A.4.1.1 Plate thickness. Plate thickness as measured by the ballistic test agency shall be used to determine the required ballistic limit for the plate. Individual thickness measurements are to be read from a micrometer to the nearest 0.001 inch and the average of these readings reported to the nearest 0.001 inch. At least one measurement shall be taken along each edge of the plate at a distance of at least one inch from the edge, but preferably in the area which shall be impacted. The average of the measurements to the nearest 0.001 inch shall be used to determine the minimum ballistic limit requirements in the appropriate tables (tables A-I through A-III). The required ballistic limit shall be determined by interpolation, if necessary, in the tables in the Appendix.

A.4.1.2 Rejection and retest of ballistic plates.

A.4.1.2.1 First article tests (rejection). Unless noted otherwise in the contract or order, failure of either of the first article test plates to meet the minimum ballistic requirements as specified in the Appendix to this specification indicates failure of the product and process.

A.4.1.2.2 First article (retests). Resubmission of ballistic retest plates shall not be made until the manufacturer has made the necessary corrections in the processing of the material to the satisfaction of the procuring activity. Two retest plates must be submitted for first article testing and both must pass.

A.4.1.2.3 Acceptance tests (rejection). Unless otherwise noted in the contract or order, failure of a test plate to meet the ballistic requirements indicates failure of the lot, however, the final decision shall depend on the outcome of retests, if submitted.



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A.4.1.2.4 Acceptance tests (retests). If a test plate representing a lot fails to meet the ballistic requirements, the manufacturer has the following options. Immediately upon notification of the failure:

a. At manufacturer's expense submit two additional test plates from the same lot for ballistic retest, or
b. First reheat treat (quenching and tempering) the lot and then submit a test plate from the retreated lot, or
c. Scrap the lot and submit a plate representing a new lot for acceptance.

If the manufacturer chooses any one of these options and the ballistic retest plate (or plates) meets the requirements, then the lot represented is acceptable. If option (1) is chosen and one or both of the retest plates fail, the manufacturer may reheat treat the lot and submit a test plate from the retreated lot. If this plate fails, the lot is rejected. If option (3) is chosen and the test plate fails, any one of the three options may be chosen again. The manufacturer shall report the processing used on the failed plates.

A.4.1.3 Disposition of ballistic test plates.

A.4.1.3.1 First article test plates. Upon request of the applicant within 15 days after ballistic testing, first article plates shall be returned "as is" to the applicant, at their expense, unless the plates were destroyed in testing.

A.4.1.3.2 Acceptance test plates. Acceptance test plates that comply with the requirements of this specification are considered as part of the lot of steel they represent and ownership of them passes to the Government with the acceptance of that lot. Acceptance test plates that fail to comply with the requirements of this specification are considered as part of the lot they represent and remain the property of the producer just as the rejected lot does. The failed plates shall be returned, upon request, as in A.4.1.3.1.



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APPENDIX A

TABLE A-I. Minimum required ballistic limits - 7.62 mm M80 ball projectile at 0 degrees obliquity.

| Thickness inches | Required BL(P), ft/sec | Thickness inches | Required BL(P), ft/sec |
|---|---|---|---|
| 0.090 | 1423 | 0.122 | 1827 |
| 0.091 | 1436 | 0.123 | 1840 |
| 0.092 | 1449 | 0.124 | 1852 |
| 0.093 | 1461 | 0.125 | 1865 |
| 0.094 | 1474 | 0.126 | 1877 |
| 0.095 | 1487 | 0.127 | 1889 |
| 0.096 | 1499 | 0.128 | 1902 |
| 0.097 | 1512 | 0.129 | 1915 |
| 0.098 1/ | 1525 | 0.130 | 1927 |
| 0.099 | 1538 | 0.131 | 1939 |
| 0.100 | 1550 | 0.132 | 1952 |
| 0.101 | 1563 | 0.133 | 1964 |
| 0.102 | 1576 | 0.134 | 1977 |
| 0.103 | 1588 | 0.135 | 1989 |
| 0.104 | 1601 | 0.136 | 2001 |
| 0.105 | 1613 | 0.137 | 2014 |
| 0.106 | 1626 | 0.138 | 2026 |
| 0.107 | 1639 | 0.139 | 2039 |
| 0.108 | 1652 | 0.140 | 2051 |
| 0.109 | 1664 | 0.141 | 2063 |
| 0.110 | 1677 | 0.142 | 2076 |
| 0.111 | 1689 | 0.143 | 2088 |
| 0.112 | 1702 | 0.144 | 2101 |
| 0.113 | 1714 | 0.145 | 2113 |
| 0.114 | 1727 | 0.146 | 2125 |
| 0.115 | 1740 | 0.147 | 2138 |
| 0.116 | 1752 | 0.148 | 2150 |
| 0.117 | 1765 | 0.149 | 2162 |
| 0.118 | 1777 | 0.150 | 2175 |
| 0.119 | 1790 | 0.151 | 2187 |
| 0.120 | 1802 | 0.152 | 2200 |
| 0.121 | 1815 | 0.153 | 2211 |

1/ Specification requirements begin for this ordered thickness.

Note: Tabulated values on either side of the ordered thicknesses are for interpolation of BL(P) requirements on undersize or oversize plates.



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APPENDIX A

TABLE A-I. Minimum required ballistic limits - 7.62-mm M80 ball projectile at 0 degrees obliquity - Continued.

| Thickness inches | Required BL(P), ft/sec | Thickness inches | Required BL(P), ft/sec |
|---|---|---|---|
| 0.154 | 2224 | 0.162 | 2322 |
| 0.155 | 2236 | 0.163 | 2334 |
| 0.156 | 2249 | 0.164 | 2347 |
| 0.157 2/ | 2261 | 0.165 | 2359 |
| 0.158 | 2273 | 0.166 | 2371 |
| 0.159 | 2285 | 0.167 | 2383 |
| 0.160 | 2298 | 0.168 | 2396 |
| 0.161 | 2310 | 0.169 | 2408 |

2/ Specification requirements end for this ordered thickness.

Note: Tabulated values on either side of the ordered thicknesses are for interpolation of BL(P) requirements on undersize or oversize plates.



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APPENDIX A

TABLE A-II. Minimum required ballistic limits - caliber .30 AP M2 projectile at 30 degrees obliquity.

| Thickness inches | Required BL(P), ft/sec Class 1 | Required BL(P), ft/sec Class 2 | Thickness inches | Required BL(P), ft/sec Class 1 | Required BL(P), ft/sec Class 2 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0.140 | 1333 | TBD | 0.240 | 2281 | 2418 |
| 0.145 | 1393 | TBD | 0.245 | 2315 | 2447 |
| 0.150 | 1453 | TBD | 0.250 | 2349 | 2474 |
| 0.155 | 1510 | TBD | 0.255 | 2381 | 2501 |
| 0.158 1/ | 1544 | TBD | 0.260 | 2411 | 2527 |
| 0.160 | 1566 | TBD | 0.265 | 2441 | 2553 |
| 0.165 | 1621 | TBD | 0.270 | 2470 | 2578 |
| 0.170 | 1674 | TBD | 0.275 | 2498 | TBD |
| 0.175 | 1726 | TBD | 0.280 | 2525 | TBD |
| 0.180 | 1777 | TBD | 0.285 | 2551 | TBD |
| 0.185 | 1826 | TBD | 0.290 | 2575 | TBD |
| 0.190 | 1873 | TBD | 0.295 | 2599 | TBD |
| 0.195 | 1920 | TBD | 0.300 2/ | 2622 | TBD |
| 0.200 | 1965 | TBD | 0.305 | 2644 | TBD |
| 0.205 | 2009 | TBD | 0.310 | 2665 | TBD |
| 0.210 | 2051 | TBD | 0.315 | 2686 | TBD |
| 0.215 | 2093 | TBD | 0.320 | 2705 | TBD |
| 0.220 | 2133 | TBD | 0.325 | 2723 | TBD |
| 0.225 | 2172 | TBD | 0.330 | 2741 | TBD |
| 0.230 | 2209 | TBD | 0.335 | 2758 | TBD |
| 0.235 | 2246 | TBD | 0.340 | 2774 | TBD |

1/ Specification requirements begin for this ordered thickness.
2/ Specification requirements end for this ordered thickness.

Note: Tabulated values on either side of the ordered thicknesses are for interpolation of BL(P) requirements on undersize or oversize plates.



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APPENDIX A

TABLE A-III. Minimum required ballistic limits - caliber .50 AP M2 projectile at 30 degrees obliquity.

| Thickness inches | Required BL(P), ft/sec | Thickness inches | Required BL(P), ft/sec |
|---|---|---|---|
| 0.290 | 1920 | 0.435 | 2351 |
| 0.295 | 1935 | 0.440 | 2365 |
| 0.300 | 1952 | 0.445 | 2379 |
| 0.301 1/ | 1955 | 0.450 | 2393 |
| 0.305 | 1967 | 0.455 | 2407 |
| 0.310 | 1983 | 0.460 | 2421 |
| 0.315 | 1999 | 0.465 | 2434 |
| 0.320 | 2014 | 0.470 | 2448 |
| 0.325 | 2029 | 0.475 | 2462 |
| 0.330 | 2045 | 0.480 | 2475 |
| 0.335 | 2060 | 0.485 | 2489 |
| 0.340 | 2075 | 0.490 | 2502 |
| 0.345 | 2090 | 0.495 | 2516 |
| 0.350 | 2105 | 0.500 | 2529 |
| 0.355 | 2120 | 0.505 | 2542 |
| 0.360 | 2135 | 0.510 | 2556 |
| 0.365 | 2150 | 0.515 | 2569 |
| 0.370 | 2165 | 0.520 | 2582 |
| 0.375 | 2180 | 0.525 | 2595 |
| 0.380 | 2194 | 0.530 | 2608 |
| 0.385 | 2209 | 0.535 | 2621 |
| 0.390 | 2223 | 0.540 | 2634 |
| 0.395 | 2238 | 0.545 | 2647 |
| 0.400 | 2252 | 0.550 | 2660 |
| 0.405 | 2266 | 0.555 | 2673 |
| 0.410 | 2281 | 0.560 | 2686 |
| 0.415 | 2295 | 0.565 | 2699 |
| 0.420 | 2309 | 0.570 | 2712 |
| 0.425 | 2323 | 0.575 | 2725 |
| 0.430 | 2338 | 0.580 | 2738 |

1/ Specification requirements begin for this ordered thickness.

Note: Tabulated values on either side of the ordered thicknesses are for interpolation of BL(P) requirements on undersize or oversize plates.



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APPENDIX A

TABLE A-III. Minimum required ballistic limits - caliber .50 AP M2 projectile at 30 degrees obliquity - Continued.

| Thickness inches | Required BL(P), ft/sec | Thickness inches | Required BL(P), ft/sec |
|---|---|---|---|
| 0.585 | 2751 | 0.625 | 2851 |
| 0.590 | 2763 | 0.630 2/ | 2864 |
| 0.595 | 2776 | 0.635 | 2876 |
| 0.600 | 2788 | 0.640 | 2888 |
| 0.605 | 2801 | 0.645 | 2901 |
| 0.610 | 2814 | 0.650 | 2913 |
| 0.615 | 2826 | 0.655 | 2925 |
| 0.620 | 2839 | 0.660 | 2938 |

2/ Specification requirements end for this ordered thickness.

Note: Tabulated values on either side of the ordered thicknesses are for interpolation of BL(P) requirements on undersize or oversize plates.



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CONCLUDING MATERIAL

Custodian:
Army - MR

Preparing activity:
Army - MR

Project 9515-2025-005

Review activities:
Army - AR, AT, TE

NOTE: The activities listed above were interested in this document as of the date of this document. Since organizations and responsibilities can change, you should verify the currency of the information above using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil.



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